太阳的背面
Shadow of the Sun

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蜗牛行迹
Slithering Snails COL-310401

蜗牛行迹
Slithering Snails

???，练习室
???, Practice Room

教练：今天还好吗?
Coach: Everything alright?

夏洛特：……不好，我的腿还是很酸痛……也许是拉伸过度了。
Charlotte: *hiss* Ah, no. Not really, my leg's still painful. I probably overdid it when I was stretching.

教练：夏洛特，我再给你 5 分钟热身，别找借口。
Coach: No excuses. Charlotte, I'm giving you five more minutes to warm up.

夏洛特：5 分钟……
Charlotte: Five minutes ...

教练：如果你想，我也可以放你一个永无止境的长假。
Coach: If you want, I can send you off on a permanent break.

她脸上再次出现了近似讥嘲的笑容——年幼的女孩再也忍不住了。
A smirk appears on the young girl's face. She can hold her feelings back no longer.

夏洛特：我完全是按照编排做的动作……
Charlotte: I followed the choreography to the letter.

教练：既然你照着我的话做了，为什么还要在这里进行这些无意义的反驳?
Coach: Why? If you'd done that, we wouldn't be having this discussion right now, would we?

夏洛特：……
Charlotte: ...

教练：夏洛特，怎么不说话?
Coach: Come on then, Charlotte, speak up. What is it? Cat got your tongue, or what?

教练：你还是离不开你那可笑的自尊心吗?
Coach: Your pathetic pride?

夏洛特：我……
Charlotte: I—

教练：好了，我不想听理由。
Coach: I don't want to hear any excuses.

教练不耐烦地挥了挥手。
She waves her hand impatiently.

教练：再来一次——别让我觉得你是个废物，夏洛特。
Coach: Again! Don't let me think you're a failure now, Charlotte.

苛刻的女人打开了钢线录音机，音乐刺入了女孩的耳膜。
She turns on the wire recorder, and the music pierces Charlotte's eardrums.

年幼的体操运动员深吸一口气。当她抬起头时，一个笑容正挂在她的脸上。
The young Floor Ritualist takes a deep breath. When she lifts her head, a smile is plastered on her face.

音乐进行着。
The music plays on.

教练： 手抬高！
Coach: Raise your hand!

她连忙把手递得更高。
She grabs her wrist and lifts it higher.

教练： 踢腿！幅度不够！
Coach: Kick! With range, I say!

她绷直脚尖，把腿送得更远。
She points her toes as she extends her leg to capacity.

教练： 很好。
Coach: Good.

客观、中肯的评价。
An objective and fair assessment.

她的心头一松，随即开始下一个动作——这是“自由祭祀”最为关键的一环。
She feels a bit relaxed and proceeds to the next move—the most crucial step of any Floor Ritual routine.

选手需要将对神秘术的理解融入到表演效果中，达到躯体、思想、情感与神秘术四者的合一。
The performer must integrate their understanding of arcanum into their performance, unifying body, mind, emotion, and arcane skill.

对参赛者来说，这也是最为困难的一环。
For competitors, this is also the most challenging part.

教练： 不对——你的神秘术呢！
Coach: Wrong! Where's your arcane skill?!

教练： 停下！停下！
Coach: Stop! Stop!

愤怒的教练员喝止了这次训练，她望向女孩，视线冷得像一块冰。
She turns off the wire recorder, bringing the practice to an immediate halt. She casts an ice-cold glare in the girl's direction.

教练： 你又忘记动作了，夏洛特。
Coach: You forgot the routine again, Charlotte.

夏洛特： 我没有——
Charlotte: I didn't ...

教练： 你为什么没有把动作连接起来？为什么在这么关键的时候犹豫?！这动作至少值 1.2 分！
Coach: Really now? Then why didn't you connect the elements? Why would you hesitate at the most important part of the whole bloody thing?! This element is worth at least 1.2 points!

教练： 你知道 1.2 分意味着什么吗？1.2 分足够让你掉下三个名次！
Coach: Do you understand what that means? 1.2 points could be the difference between first and fourth!

严苛的女人长长地舒出一口气。
She lets out a deep sigh.

教练： 你真是个废物，夏洛特。我对你太失望了。
Coach: You're a failure, Charlotte. I can't tell you how disappointed I am in you.

夏洛特：但是我之前的动作都很准确，上一个教练告诉过我，我的动作是最标准的……
Charlotte: But everything else up to then was perfect! My last coach told me my movements were the most standard she'd seen.

眼前的女人发出了一声嗤笑。
The coach sneers.

教练：那这丢失的 1.2 分，你要从哪里找回来？从前教练的嘴里吗？小姑娘，赛制不会因为你用不出这个神秘术而修改。
Coach: So where are you going to find those 1.2 points you just lost? In your old coach's mouth? You listen to me now, girlie, the competition rules don't bend to accommodate little girls who can't use their arcane skills.

教练：别自大，夏洛特，我见过别的“自由祭祀”选手。她们每一个的神秘术都比你用得更生动。
Coach: Don't get cocky, Charlotte. I've seen my fair share of Floor Ritualists in my time, and your arcane skills are by far the least impressive.

教练：好好想想吧……你是得想想了。
Coach: Think about it. You need to have a long, hard think about what happened here today.

女人近似于呢喃地说道。随后，她深深地叹了一口气，离开了训练室。
She murmurs this, as if she's almost speaking to herself, then sighs and leaves the training room.

夏洛特：……
Charlotte: ...

夏洛特：我绝不是废物……！
Charlotte: I'm not a failure!

笃笃骨的家
Willow's House

笃笃骨：……
Willow: ...

一段糟糕的噩梦，她暗暗地咬了咬牙齿。
A terrible nightmare. She grits her teeth in the dim light of her bedroom.

墙上的时钟已经走向了 7 点——快到那个约定的时间了。沉默的女巫为自己装上假肢。
The clock on the wall inches toward 7 o'clock. It's almost time for her appointment. She slides her legs off the edge of the bed and attaches her prosthetic limb.

在器械长年的压迫下，肢体的残端总是有着微微的肿胀。随着她的动作，假肢咯吱咯吱的响声回荡在寂静的室内。
Her stump is always slightly swollen due to the constant and prolonged pressure of her artificial appendage. As she moves, its creaking echoes through the otherwise silent room.

叮铃铃——
ring-ring-ring

笃笃骨：该死的！在这种时候……
Willow: Bloody hell. Just perfect timing ...

迫于亟待处理的事物，女巫未经检视地扣上了皮质束带。
然而这脆弱的连结在她起身的那一刻乍然断裂，使她整个身体重重地坠向地面。
She hastily fastens the leather strap of her prosthetic leg. As she stands, her poor fastening comes loose, causing her to fall heavily to the ground.

???：女巫小姐！屋子里有好大的响声！你摔倒了吗？
???: Ms. Willow! I heard a loud bang just now. Have you taken a tumble?

遥远的声音自门扉之外传来。
A young voice echoes from the other side of the door.

???: 女巫小姐，请问可以给我开门吗？蜗牛要爬到我的手上了！
???: Ms. Willow, could you open the door for me? One of the snails is about to crawl up my hand!

笃笃骨: 见鬼——！
Willow: Oh, have a feckin' laugh, why don't you?!

她顾不上那支假肢了，整个人跌跌撞撞地摔在了门框上。随后，她一脸阴沉地打开了门。
She hops over to the door and opens it with a sullen expression on her face. Her prosthetic is left lying on the floor.

纸信圈儿: 来啦，女巫小姐……这是这周的蜗牛。
Flutterpage: Here you go, Ms. Willow! Your snails for the week.

笃笃骨: ……
Willow: ...

纸信圈儿: 你还好吗?
Flutterpage: You alright?

笃笃骨: ——别问这些，把蜗牛给我。
Willow: Mind your own business, will you? Give me the snails.

女孩眨了眨眼睛，随后将那只铁皮桶递到了女巫的鼻子下方，里面装满了蜗牛。
Flutterpage blinks, then holds the jar of snails up to Willow.

笃笃骨: 去门口的邮筒，拿你这周的报酬。
Willow: Hurry on to the letterbox and pick up your reward for the week.

纸信圈儿: 我可以换一种报酬吗，女巫小姐?
Flutterpage: Could you give me a different reward this week, Ms. Willow?

笃笃骨: 什么?
Willow: What?

纸信圈儿: 我想知道，你每天都在屋子里做些什么呢?
Flutterpage: I'm thinking ... For my reward, could you tell me what you do at home all day?

纸信圈儿: 汤普顿说这个屋子里每天都有怪声响，就像一百只青蛙同时在叫唤——这是你的神秘术吗?你为什么拥有这样的神秘术?
Flutterpage: Thompson says there are strange noises coming from this house every day, like a hundred frogs croakin' at the same time. Is that your arcane skill? Why's your arcane skill like that?

纸信圈儿: 女巫小姐，你可以告诉我，我要怎样才能——
Flutterpage: Ms. Willow, can you tell me how-how I can—

笃笃骨: 滚出我的院子！
Willow: Get out of my garden!

纸信圈儿: 诶？可是……
Flutterpage: But ...

笃笃骨: 你没听清楚吗？我让你——
Willow: Did you hear me? I said:

出去！
GET OUT OF HERE!

话音未落，眼前的门“砰”地一声关上了。
Before she even finishes her exclamation, she has already slammed the door shut.

润滑脂
Lubricant COL-310402

润滑脂
Machine Lubricant

门扉合上之后，单腿无法再承担身躯的重量，女巫狼狈地跌坐在了地上。
As the door closes, her solitary leg can no longer bear the weight of her body, and she falls to the ground in disgrace.

笃笃骨：呼……
Willow: Huff ...

伴随着金属卡扣的合拢声，她将假肢妥帖地安装在了残肢的末端——至少现在，她看上去像一个普通人了。
She reaches for her prosthetic leg and closes the metal clasps around her stump. At least now she looks like an ordinary person.

笃笃骨：好了，接下来看看这些蜗牛吧。这些没有脚的东西……
Willow: Alright, let's take a look at these snails. These footless little things.

笃笃骨：……或者说，它们全身都是脚——是那种名叫“腹足”的身体结构。
Willow: Or I suppose their entire body is a foot. That's why they're called "gastropods."

笃笃骨：用它的黏液来制作润滑剂，也许真的能对腿有些好处……
Willow: Anyway, the swelling in my leg has gone down since I started using their mucus as lubricant.

她将那些蜗牛放置在桌面上，一列摆开。看着它们在陌生的环境中移动，留下一道晶亮的黏液。
One by one, she places the snails on a table, arranging them neatly side by side. As they crawl forward, they leave a trail of shiny mucus.

笃笃骨：好极了，就是这样，再走得远一点……
Willow: Good, just like that. Keep it up now.

她紧盯着蜗牛，那些软体动物正探头探脑地爬行着。
She closely monitors the snails as they make their way across the table, and its surface starts to shine with mucus.

笃笃骨：——你落后了！3 号选手！
Willow: You're falling behind, Number 3!

第三只蜗牛似乎受到了不轻的惊吓，至今没能从壳中钻出来。
The third snail has curled up inside its shell.

笃笃骨：5 号选手现在开始发力，超越了 1 号选手，但离冠军还有相当的距离——
Willow: Number 5 is gaining speed, overtaking Number 1, but victory is still far off.

第五只蜗牛慢悠悠地伸长了它的触须，超越了第一只蜗牛。
The fifth snail extends its body, slowly overtaking snail Number 1.

笃笃骨：该死的！8 号选手，你不知道比赛规则吗？不能爬到 5 号选手的身上去！
Willow: Bloody hell! Honestly, Number 8, don't you know the rules? You can't climb on top of Number 5!

两只蜗牛滚成一团，从桌子的边缘掉了下去。
The two snails roll into a ball and fall off the edge of the table.

笃笃骨：遗憾出局。
Willow: I'm afraid you're both disqualified.

第七只蜗牛爬得最远，但女巫对此不发一言。她只是俯瞰着它，以一种奇异的冷酷态度。
Number 7 has crawled the farthest, but Willow says nothing. She simply looks down at it with a strange coldness in her eyes.

她等待着，直到第七只蜗牛爬到了桌子的彼端——假设这是一场田径比赛，则计时理应在此时结束。
She waits until it reaches the other end of the table. If this were a real race, the timer would end now.

笃笃骨：让我来宣布，最后的获胜者是——1 号选手！
Willow: Allow me to announce the results. The winner is—Number 1!

女巫趾高气扬地裁定了比赛的结果。
She declares the result, a hint of bitterness in her voice.

笃笃骨：但很可惜，即使你获胜了，终点也不会有金牌在等你——因为这不是田径比赛。
Willow: But unfortunately, this isn't a real race. There'll be no gold medal waiting for you at the finish line.

笃笃骨：我只是需要尽可能多的黏液而已——这才是比赛的规则。
Willow: I simply need as much mucus as possible. That's the only purpose of this.

她把所有的蜗牛丢入了铁皮桶里，随后驾轻就熟地收集了桌子上的黏液。
She gathers the snails and tosses them into the jar before deftly collecting the mucus from the table.

笃笃骨：羊脂蜗牛的黏液、雨燕的唾液……再搭配一些触媒。
Willow: Snail mucus, swiftlet saliva, and a few catalysts.

坩埚中的物质柔滑而驯服。笃笃骨用铲子挑起了一点儿，窗外的光线穿过了半透明的膏脂，闪烁出动人的光泽。
The translucent ointment in the crucible is smooth and docile. Willow scoops some of it up with a spatula. It catches the light through the window, scintillating with a charming luster.

笃笃骨：很好的半成品——只需要再用一个冷却咒。
Willow: A fine semifinished salve. All it needs now is a cooling incantation.

笃笃骨：寒风凛凛！
Willow: Howling winds of winter!

膏脂凝结成了淡淡的乳黄色。
The ointment solidifies, becoming a pale yellow.

一如往日地，女巫将这些润滑脂涂抹在了假肢的关节上——直到关节在活动时不再发出“咯吱”的声响。
As usual, she removes her prosthetic and applies the lubricant to the joints. She moves it around, ensuring that it no longer creaks.

笃笃骨：勉勉强强。
Willow: I suppose that'll do.

她替自己装上了腿，故作轻巧地跳动着，金属的肢体叩击在地板上，发出沉闷的响声。
She fits the prosthetic once again and hops with a feigned lightness, the metal limb clanking on the floor as she does so.

她用那一条更沉重的腿作为支撑，抬起了那条健全的腿。
She lifts her good leg, using the prosthetic for support.

小孩 I：你听见了吗？从鬼婆屋子里传来的响声。
Kid I: Hey. You hear that? It's coming from the hag's house!

几不可闻的窃语声从室外传来。
Children's voices seep in from outside.

小孩 II： 她又在做什么古怪的仪式?
Kid II: I wonder what kind of curse she's cookin' up now.

小孩 II： 叔叔告诉我，要小心从爱尔兰来的女巫，她们的眼睛是红色的，脚趾上还长着青蛙一样的蹼——汤普顿，你看到过她的脚吗?
Kid II: My uncle told me to watch out for Irish witches. They have big red eyes and webbed toes like a frog's. Have you ever seen her feet, Thompson?

小孩 I： 我没有看见过——
Kid I: No ...

小孩 II： 真没劲。
Kid II: Ugh. Booorin'.

女巫无法听见这些声音，她正在尝试一种复杂的旋转——如果在“自由祭祀”的赛场上完美做出这个动作，那么计分板上将增加 0.6 的分值。
The "hag" is far too busy to pay attention to these voices. She is attempting a complex Floor Ritual element. If executed perfectly, she would gain an additional o.6 points in a competition.

身体下倾，钢铁制成的肢体高高抬起，下压。
She tilts her body downward, lifting her steel limb high into the air, then presses down.

而外面的争论声与此同时变得激烈。
Meanwhile, the argument outside intensifies.

小孩 I： 但我知道！鬼婆的一只脚会发出青蛙一样的叫声，呱——呱呱——
Kid I: I see. One of her feet makes a sound like a croaking frog. Ribbit, ribbit.

小孩 I： ……就像是房间里的那个声音！
Kid I: Actually, it's just like the sound coming from her house right now!

小孩 II： 什么……?
Kid II: What?

即使有了润滑，假肢依然不受控制地发出了刺耳的摩擦声，而女巫还在奋力地下压，直到她的脊椎同钢铁一并发出哀嚎。
Even after lubrication, her prosthetic still makes a harsh scraping sound. Willow presses down with all her might until her spine and the steel groan together.

笃笃骨： 还不够。
Willow: Not enough.

笃笃骨： 这只是——金属的重量，而不是我自身的力量……
Willow: This is just the weight of the metal, not my own strength.

她咬紧牙关，将腿部压得更低。随着动作幅度的增大，金属假肢发出了更剧烈的响声。
She grits her teeth and presses her leg down lower. As her body extends, the metal prosthetic screeches louder.

咯吱——咯吱——
screech—screech

笃笃骨： 啊……!
Willow: Urgh!

动作失误了。她失去平衡，又一次摔倒了。
She loses her balance and falls to the floor once again.

小孩 I： ……是惨叫声！鬼婆一定又抓了人在做邪恶的药剂!
Kid I: Perhaps she's caught someone! She's probably throwin' them in her cauldron as we speak!

小孩 I： ——我们得救出那些人！
Kid I: We have to go rescue them!

小孩 II： 我们该怎么办？要回去告诉大人吗？
Kid II: Er—What should we do? Fetch some grownups?

小孩 I： 大人都是胆小鬼，他们只会躲得远远的，艾伯特，我们得救出被鬼婆抓住的人——你去周围拿点石头过来！
Kid I: Pah! Grownups are all a bunch of chickens. They'll just tell us to stay away. No, it's down to us, Albert. We have to go save whoever the hag has caught before it's too late! Quick, grab some stones!

急促的奔跑声。
The sound of hurried footsteps echoes through the garden.

一块石头携带着破碎的玻璃碴，砸在了笃笃骨的身侧。
crash A stone smashes through the window and hits the floor near Willow's feet.

小孩 I： 怪鬼婆，坏鬼婆！你有本事就出来抓我啊！
Kid I: You wicked old hag! Come out and catch me if you can!

笃笃骨： 该死的——
Willow: Bloody hell!

伴随着玻璃的破碎声，又一颗石头被掷入了室内。
Another stone, and another crash of breaking glass.

笃笃骨： 讨人厌的小鬼！
Willow: Scheming little devils!

她罔顾肢体的疼痛，对着窗外大声吼叫。
Ignoring the pain in her limb, she goes to the window to yell at them.

笃笃骨： 滚开！
Willow: Get away with you!

小孩 II： 鬼婆……呜哇！
Kid II: Waaahhh! It's the hag!

又来了，孩子的哭叫。
There it is again. Another wailing child.

笃笃骨： 给我闭嘴——！
Willow: Shut your mouth!

孩子的哭声奇迹般地消失了。
Miraculously, the crying actually ceases.

笃笃骨： 你们都……
Willow: All of you ...

笃笃骨： 离开我的花园！
Willow: Get the bloody hell out of my garden!

润滑脂
Lubricant COL-310403

花园
Garden

笃笃骨： 这是……
Willow: This is ...

尽管只是一个仿制品，但那确实是一枚金牌。
Although an imitation, it is indeed a gold medal.

小孩 II： 把我的金牌还给我！
Kid II: Hey! Give me back my gold medal!

一块拙劣的仿制品，上面雕刻着粗糙的火焰。
Flames have been crudely carved upon its surface.

笃笃骨： 这个金牌是哪里来的?
Willow: Where did you get this from?

小孩 II： 我为什么要告诉你?
Kid II: Why should I tell you?

孩子抿紧了嘴唇，露出一副坚毅的表情。
The child presses his lips tightly shut, a determined look in his eyes.

笃笃骨： 告诉我。
Willow: Tell me.

小孩 II： ……
Kid II: ...

小孩 I： 这、这是乌卢鲁运动会的纪念品……是玛莎姐姐送给我们的。她说这能够给人带来好运……
Kid I: That's a souvenir from the Uluru Games! Sister Martha gave it to us. She said it would bring us good luck.

小孩 II： 汤普顿！
Kid II: Thompson!

小孩 I： 我都告诉你了，你能不能放我们走？鬼……女巫小姐！
Kid I: Th-That's everything I know. Can you let us go now?

女巫露出一丝讥嘲的冷笑。
The "hag" gives a mocking sneer.

笃笃骨： 是吗？看来这枚金牌的确给你们带来了好运。
Willow: Is that so? So the medal did bring you good luck after all.

笃笃骨： 拿着它，然后……
Willow: Go on, take it. Take it and ...

笃笃骨： 滚出我的花园！
Willow: Get Out!

无翼飞鸟
Fallen Swan COL-310404

无翼飞鸟
Fallen Swan

闹剧结束了。
The farce has come to an end.

花园中稀疏的植物被这场意外搅弄得东倒西歪，淡紫色的土豆花落在了土壤上。
The sparse vegetation in her garden has been left in disarray by the incident. The purple potato flowers lie scattered upon the soil.

祖母：真好啊，又是土豆丰收的季节。
Grandma: Nice! It's spud season again.

祖母：夏洛特，今天的早餐是土豆泥哦，特地加了很多甜奶油的土豆泥——你最爱吃这些了，不是吗?
Grandma: Charlotte, I've made ye mashed tatties for breakfast today, with plenty of sweet cream—yer favorite.

夏洛特：……教练不让我吃这些。“自由祭祀”需要运动员保持身材。教练说，如果要拿到金牌，就一定……
Charlotte: Coach says I can't eat this anymore. Floor Ritualists need to keep their figures trim. She says that if I want to win the gold, I need to—

祖母：可怜的小夏洛特……连饭都不能吃饱了。
Grandma: Oh, Charlotte. Now they've got ye worried about yer eating too?

祖母：我们都知道你是乖孩子，也很喜欢“自由祭祀”。但每天要做这么多的训练，你又这么小，总得吃饱了才有力气。
Grandma: I know you're a good little thing, and you like yer Floor Ritual very much, but with all that training ye do, and with all this growing you've still to do, you have to eat properly, otherwise you'll wither away into nothing!

祖母：只吃一小口，怎么样?
Grandma: Just take one bite, eh? How about it?

夏洛特：一小口……
Charlotte: One bite ...

教练：——你早上吃了什么?
Coach: What did you have for breakfast?

她紧紧地盯着女孩胸前残余的一小块土豆泥。
Her eyes are fixed on the small clump of mashed potatoes left hanging on the girl's chest.

教练：奶油土豆泥?
Coach: Creamy mashed potatoes?

她陡然拔高了声调。
Before the girl can react, she explodes.

教练：我和你说过多少次了！如果你还想取得成绩，就不能再吃这些东西！
Coach: How many times have I told you?! If you want results, you can't eat rubbish like this!

夏洛特：……我只是在补充热量。
Charlotte: I was just trying to get a little energy.

她知道自己在狡辩。
They both know this is just an excuse.

教练：三天后就是乌卢鲁预选赛，你想过这个问题吗？
Coach: The Uluru qualifiers are in three days, Charlotte! Did you forget that little fact?

教练：还是说，你以为有了那一点可笑的天赋，就拥有了在赛场上傲慢的资格？
Coach: Or do you think that pathetic speck of talent of yours gives you the right to get complacent? Eh?!

教练：如果你是这么认为的，那么我现在就要告诉你，夏洛特。
Coach: If that's what you think, then let me tell you now, Charlotte.

女人露出了一个残酷的微笑。
A cruel smile spreads across her face.

教练：你是个彻头彻尾的废物。
Coach: What a waste of space you are.

教练：在乌卢鲁的赛场上，从来不缺少天才。
Coach: There'll be no shortage of talent at the qualifiers.

夏洛特：我知道我做得不对——但为什么要这样羞辱我……！
Charlotte: Why? I know I shouldn't have done it, but you don't need to humiliate me like this!

教练：羞辱？
Coach: Humiliate you?

冷酷的女人忽然笑了起来。
She gives a sharp, cruel laugh.

教练：如果你认为这是羞辱，那我只能告诉你——你差得太远了，你不配和其他选手在同一个赛场上角逐那块金牌。
Coach: You're right. I don't need to humiliate you. Because the moment you walk out on that floor beside real athletes, you'll have already done it to yourself.

教练：当然，这也是你的自由。
Coach: Go ahead. I won't stop you.

女人轻飘飘地扔下了一句话。
She is casual in the face of this cruel remark.

夏洛特：……
Charlotte: ...

教练：去啊，去吃你最喜欢的奶油土豆泥吧；然后取消上午的训练，因为你要保证足够的睡眠……噢，下午的训练也尽可以取消了。
Coach: Go ahead and eat your creamy mashed potatoes if you love them so much. Oh, and Her Majesty needs her beauty sleep, too. Why not go ahead and cancel your morning training? In fact, why not take the whole day off?

教练：运动可太辛苦了，不仅要忍受肌肉的酸痛，还要控制饮食、受到教练的责骂。你可是尊贵的奥黑根小姐啊。
Coach: Sports are just too exhausting, I know. Not only do you have to put up with your aching muscles, but you have to watch what you eat and deal with your bossy old coach. After all, you're Lady Charlotte, a fine noblewoman.

教练：这样尊贵的小姐，怎么能在乌卢鲁的红土地上流汗呢？她就该坐在观众席上才对——是了，至少还得有遮阳伞和冷饮，我说得对吗？
Coach: How could a noble be asked to sweat on the red land of Uluru? She should be sitting in the audience, yes, in the audience with a parasol and a cool drink, no?

教练：我不会再在你身上浪费精力了。
Coach: I shan't waste my energy on you any longer.

严苛的女人朝她露出了一个冷笑，随后头也不回地离开了训练场。
She turns and exits the training ground without a backward glance.

夏洛特：……
Charlotte: ...

她慢慢地握紧了拳头。
Charlotte slowly clenches her fists.

夏洛特：该死的——！
Charlotte: Feck!

夏洛特：我才不是……
Charlotte: I'm not ...

她一拳砸在墙壁上，指骨传来的疼痛令她心有不甘。
She punches the wall, and the pain in her knuckles fills her with bitterness.

夏洛特：我才不是奥黑根小姐……！
Charlotte: I am not Lady Charlotte!!

她咬紧牙关，鼻腔酸涩。
但最后她忍住了，没有让泪水超越眼眶的边界。
She grits her teeth as her sinuses sting. She holds back her emotions, not letting the tears flow from her eyes.

夏洛特：我会拿到金牌的……
Charlotte: I will win that gold medal.

她重重地把腿压在墙上，整个身体呈现出不可思议的柔软弧度。
She presses her leg hard against the wall, her whole body bending into a gentle curve.

空荡的训练室内，只有她一个人在练习那些枯燥的动作，她一遍又一遍地跳起、落下。柔软的身躯在空中划出优美的弧线。
She begins the routine she has practiced a thousand times before, but this time alone in the room. Her body traces arcs in the air as she leaps and lands through each element.

夏洛特：0.2，0.5，0.3，0.7，0.4……
Charlotte: 0.2, 0.5, 0.3, 0.7, 0.4 ...

她在心中默默地记录着每个动作的分数。
She silently records the score of each element as she goes.

接下来，是最为重要的神秘术环节。
Next comes the most important part—the arcane skill segment.

夏洛特：呼……呼……
Charlotte: Huff ... huff ...

她闭上了眼睛。
She closes her eyes.

无形的能量正在空气中流转。
Invisible energy flows through the air.

夏洛特：呼，盛……日之眼，平衡的守护者，你是……无尽之泉。
Charlotte: Phew. Eye of Day, Keeper of Balance. You are the Endless Well.

夏洛特：疗愈的苏利丝，闪耀的苏利丝……神圣的苏利丝。
Charlotte: Healing Sulis, shining Sulis, holy Sulis, to us, you tell.

隐约的光芒在眼前浮现。
A faint glow appears before her eyes.

夏洛特：你温暖我们的灵魂，拯救我们的伤口，也将赐予我们无尽的超脱……
Charlotte: You warm our souls, heal our wounds, and grant us endless peace.

那光芒温暖如春天，她朝它伸出了手。
The light is as warm as spring. She reaches out her hand to it.

夏洛特：只要我能够触摸到您的衣角……那流溢而慈爱的光辉……
Charlotte: If only I could touch the hem of your garment, that flowing, loving radiance ...

夏洛特：——！
Charlotte: ...!

夏洛特：我……是我做错了什么吗？为什么我的眼睛看不见您的光辉……？
Charlotte: Did I do something wrong? Why can't I see your radiance?

身侧的能量还在流溢着，它们鼓动着她的发丝，拂动着体操服上柔软的羽毛。
The energy still flows beside her, stirring her hair and softly ruffling the feathers on her leotard.

夏洛特：我为什么看不见您？您又为什么拒绝我？我要怎样才能获得您的垂青呢？
Charlotte: Why can't I see you? Why do you reject me? How can I win your favor?

无尽的黑暗中，只有她的声音在回荡。
In the endless darkness, her voice is the only echo.

夏洛特：只要您愿意，我可以拿我拥有的一切来交换——只要能让我拿到那块金牌，我什么都愿意付出！
Charlotte: I'll do anything—give you anything—just please, let me win that gold medal!

教练：哈。
Coach: Hah.

耳畔传来了不应在此刻出现的声音，女孩惊慌地睁开了眼睛。
That voice shouldn't be here. She opens her eyes, startled.

夏洛特：您怎么——
Charlotte: What are you—

教练：我来拿录音机。
Coach: I came to get the wire recorder.

夏洛特：……录音机？
Charlotte: The wire recorder?

录音机是公用的设施，它一直被放置在训练室内——通常情况下，并不会有人特意将它拿走。
But the wire recorder is for everyone to use. It's always in the training room. She's never seen anyone take it out of here before.

教练：夏洛特，竞技体育的残酷之处就在于，即使你付出了一切，也极有可能一无所有。
Coach: Charlotte, the cruelty of competitive sports is that even if you give everything, you're very likely to end up with nothing in return.

女人自顾自地说了下去。
She continues, half speaking to herself.

教练：我原本以为你会明白这一切，但没想到你是个令人叹为观止的蠢货。
Coach: I thought you'd understand this. But, no, you're just a ridiculous, foolish little girl.

教练：想想你的前辈吧。西尔莎，所有人都认为她一定能拿下那一届冠军，包括她的对手。
Coach: Think about those who came before you. Saoirse, for example. Everyone thought she'd win the games hands down, even her competitors.

教练：最后因为一次偶然的伤病，她去不了了，只能从别人的嘴里听到乌卢鲁这三个字——后来发生了什么，你应当比我更清楚。
Coach: But in the end, she injured herself before she could compete. She never even saw Uluru for herself, only heard those three haunting syllables repeated by everyone around her. Of course, you know better than I what happened to her after that.

夏洛特：……她从伦敦桥上跳了下去。
Charlotte: She jumped off London Bridge.

教练：——你又凭什么认为，这样的命运不会发生在你的身上？
Coach: What makes you think you won't be the next? That you won't end up like her?

夏洛特：我……
Charlotte: I—

教练：起来！
Coach: On your feet!

一声未曾预想的呵斥。
An unexpected command.

教练：把你刚刚的动作再跳一次。
Coach: The last element you just performed. Do it again.

教练：马上就到预选赛了，怎么还能跳成这样？你既然不能感知“自由祭祀”的神秘术涌动，就绝不能在这些地方犯错。
Coach: The qualifiers are just around the corner, and you're still jumping like that? If you aren't able to bring forth your arcane skill, you absolutely cannot afford to make a single mistake in the rest of your routine.

柔光
Flickering Candlelight COL-310405

柔光
Flickering Candlelight

预选赛·赛场
Uluru Qualifiers Stadium

举办预选赛的那一天，天气并不好，四周浮动着隐约的尘霾——在场的神秘学家都认为今天并不适合祭祀。
The day of the qualifiers is met with unfavorable weather, as a faint haze lingers in the air. Everyone agrees that today is not a good day for rituals.

熟悉的声音自身侧传来。
A familiar voice speaks beside her.

教练：这只是一次预选赛，我不指望你取得多高的名次。但我相信，只要你好好地做出那些动作，一定能入围后续的赛程。
Coach: These are only the qualifiers, so I don't expect you to set a world record or anything. Just perform decently well, and you'll be sure to make it through to the next round.

教练：——只要你及时感受到她，你就能做出所有动作，明白了吗？
Coach: As long as you feel her on the floor, you'll be able to complete all the elements. Understand?

夏洛特：……
Charlotte: ...

女孩说不出话，只是用力地点了点头。
The girl is too focused to speak. She gives a simple, vigorous nod.

教练：好了，去吧。相信自己。
Coach: Alright, go on then. Believe in yourself.

一只温热的手拍了拍她的肩膀，随后她走上了赛场。
A warm hand pats her shoulder as she steps onto the floor.

——伴随着音乐的响起，她少年时期最灰暗的五分钟，由此开始了。
As the music starts, the darkest five minutes of her youth begin.

???：卡洛琳选手，恭喜你在这次小组赛中获得第一。
???: *Oh! Congratulations, Caroline, on your victory on the floor.*

卡洛琳：谢谢。
Caroline Bartley: *Thank you.*

远方传来的声音模糊而细微，她无法让自己的注意力离开这些声音。
Their voices are vague and distant, yet she cannot divert her attention from them.

卡洛琳：在得知夏洛特·奥黑根也参与这次比赛之后，我并没有奢望在这次比赛中获得第一……你们知道，她是一个非常优秀的“自由祭祀”选手。
Caroline Bartley: *I must say, when I learned that Charlotte O'Hagan would be participating, I didn't expect to win first place, since we all know she's a world-class Floor Ritualist.*

夏洛特：……
Charlotte: ...

???：夏洛特·奥黑根最后的名次是第八名，很有可能无缘决赛。
???: *Charlotte O'Hagan has finished in eighth, meaning she'll most likely miss the finals.*

???：自由祭祀始终还是一个神秘学家的项目，如果只有技术分，那她为什么不去参加别的运动会呢？那儿才是技术分决定一切的地方。
???: *Floor Ritual has always had its roots in arcanum. If she's only here to compete for technical points, why doesn't she compete in another event?*

夏洛特：该死的！
Charlotte: Feck!

卡洛琳：……我不同意您的说法。
Caroline Bartley: *I beg to differ.*

卡洛琳：夏洛特是一个优秀的选手，如果您看过她的表演，就不该否认她的努力。
Caroline Bartley: *Charlotte is an outstanding player. If you had observed her performance closely, you wouldn't be making light of her efforts.*

???：但她失误了，她没有做完祭祀的动作。
???: *But she made a huge mistake. She didn't even complete the ritual segment of her routine.*

???：最关键的是——她根本没有办法保证祭祀的持续性和稳定性，您看见了吗？受到祭祀感召的乌云，在所有评委的头上下起了雨！
???: *There was a critical failure in the stability of her ritual. Didn't you see? The clouds she summoned poured rain all over the judges' heads!*

场馆内传来了零散的笑声。
There is scattered laughter throughout the venue.

卡洛琳：……
Caroline Bartley: ...

卡洛琳：抱歉，这位先生，我不会再回答您关于夏洛特·奥黑根的问题——您对“体育精神”的理解太狭隘了。
Caroline Bartley: *Sorry, sir, I will no longer answer any questions regarding Charlotte O'Hagan. I'm afraid your understanding of "sportsmanship" leaves much to be desired.*

夏洛特：……
Charlotte: ...

一阵脚步声在身边响起。
Footsteps approach from behind her.

教练：想什么呢?
Coach: What's on your mind, girl?

短暂的沉默。
A brief silence ensues.

夏洛特：不，我什么也没想，我要回家。
Charlotte: N-Nothing. I want to go home.

她准备从椅子上站起来，未曾料想一双手压着她的肩膀，把她重重地按回了原位。
She starts to lift herself up from her chair when a pair of hands presses her firmly back down.

教练：你是懦夫吗?
Coach: Are you a coward?

夏洛特：……当然不是。
Charlotte: O-Of course not.

夏洛特：我……我也不想是……懦夫……
Charlotte: I ... I don't want to be ... a coward.

她深深地低下了头，温热的液体落在了她的手背上，变成一滴微缩的湖泊。
She bows her head deeply, her tears forming little puddles on the backs of her hands.

夏洛特：可是我的想法有用吗？……难道我想获得金牌，它就会长了翅膀飞到我的脖子上吗?
Charlotte: But does it matter what I want? Will wanting to win a gold medal make it sprout wings and fly around my neck?

夏洛特：我控制不了我的神秘术，哪怕我内心的愿望如此强烈，那些能量也不会听从我的呼唤……它们变成了潮湿的云朵，我眼睁睁地看着它们飞向了评委席……
Charlotte: I can't control my arcane skill. No matter how strong I will it, the ritual energies won't heed my call. They just turned into wet clouds, and all I could do was stand there and watch them fly towards the judges' seats.

夏洛特：也许从头到尾，我就不适合这项运动——就像那个记者说的，我不该出现在这里。
Charlotte: Maybe I'm not cut out for this sport. Maybe it's just like that reporter said, and I shouldn't even be here.

教练：……听着，夏洛特。
Coach: Listen, Charlotte.

女人的声音将她拉回了现实。
The coach's voice pulls her back to reality.

教练：没人说你不该出现在这里。
Coach: No one said you shouldn't be here.

教练：你知道为什么你的祭祀术不管用吗?
Coach: Do you know why you aren't able to perform the ritual?

夏洛特：……为什么?
Charlotte: Why?

教练：因为你太在意分数了。
Coach: Because you care too much about your score.

夏洛特：可是……
Charlotte: But ...

教练：和我来。
Coach: Come with me.

花园
Garden

花园的植物茂盛地生长着。
The garden is lush with thriving plants and blooming flowers.

教练：能量的涌动留存于空气之中，你得把它当成和你一起共舞的朋友——没有人喜欢和假想敌一起跳舞。
Coach: Energy flows constantly through the air around us. You have to think of it as a friend dancing along with you. After all, who would want to dance with an imaginary enemy?

教练：闭上眼睛。
Coach: Close your eyes.

教练：这里不是乌卢鲁，你首先要忘记一切评分的规则。
Coach: This isn't Uluru. The first thing you need to do is forget about the scoring rules.

教练：念出你的祷词。
Coach: Recite your prayer.

夏洛特：盛日之眼……平衡的守护者，你是无尽之泉。
Charlotte: Eye of Day, Keeper of Balance. You are the Endless Well.

教练：继续，不必忧虑你的发音与读法，想象只是朋友间的谈话。
Coach: Go on. Don't worry about your pronunciation or delivery. Just imagine you're talking to an old friend.

夏洛特：苏利丝……疗愈的苏利丝，闪耀的苏利丝，神圣的苏利丝。
Charlotte: Healing Sulis, shining Sulis, holy Sulis, to us, you tell.

女孩的右手高高举起。
She raises her right hand high in the air.

教练：感受她的气息，感受她的能量，感受她带给你的一切……最原始的律动与流向，情绪与迷幻的色彩。
Coach: Feel her breath, feel her energy, feel all that she brings to you. Feel that primitive rhythm and flow, your emotions—that psychedelic rainbow of colors.

夏洛特：——!
Charlotte: ...!

夏洛特：有什么东西……拉起了我的手……
Charlotte: Something lifted my hand!

教练：火焰是她们的舞步，风声是她们的呼吸。我们诞生于风与火的交媾，雨水湿润如羊膜。
Coach: Flames are their dance, and wind their breath. Through wind and fire are we born, and by the rain are we swaddled.

教练：它带给我们温暖与光明，我们为何要惧怕，为何要驻足，为何要停留——
Coach: Warmth and light they bring. So, why fear, pause, or stand by?

她高唱着，声音暗合某种磅礴而古老的节拍，于她足尖的支点上，一千道影子犹如花朵般盛开。
She chants, her voice aligned with some magnificent and ancient rhythm, and from the tips of her toes, a thousand shadows bloom like flowers.

教练：夏洛特，拉着我的手，来跳舞吧。
Coach: Dance, Charlotte. Take my hand and dance.

她伸出了手，如同一个邀请。
She reaches out her hand in invitation.

夏洛特：火焰是她们的舞步，风声是她们的呼吸……
Charlotte: The flames are their steps, and wind their breath.

女孩亦步亦趋地跟随着，每一个脚步都陷入一个节拍。
She follows the movements, each step sinking into a rhythm.

夏洛特：风，火……雨水……
Charlotte: Wind ... fire ... rain ...

夏洛特：我不惧怕……
Charlotte: I am not afraid ...

夏洛特：——！
Charlotte: ...!

女孩惊愕地捂住了脸颊。
She clasps her cheek in shock.

教练：怎么了？
Coach: What is it?

夏洛特：好像有什么东西……亲了亲我。
Charlotte: Something kissed me.

教练：继续跳吧，夏洛特。
Coach: Keep dancing, Charlotte.

女人宽慰地松开了手。
The woman releases her hand comfortingly.

教练：你已经有一个更好的舞伴了——不必多想，让她来带领你。
Coach: You've already got a much better dance partner. Don't think too much. Just let her lead you.

眼前的女孩闭上了双目，她的手高举着，如同某种古老的祭礼。
The girl closes her eyes, raising her hand high in an ancient ritual.

教练：这是一条注定孤独的道路……你想好该怎么走了吗？
Coach: It's a road destined to be lonely. Have you made up your mind?

她的声音太过微小，风声很快吞没了它。
Her voice is so quiet that it is quickly swallowed by the wind.

???，练习室
???, Practice Room

夏洛特：……疗愈的苏利丝，闪耀的苏利丝，神圣的苏利丝。
Charlotte: Healing Sulis, shining Sulis, holy Sulis, to us, you tell.

漆黑的房间中，她布置下所有的触媒。
She arranges the catalysts in the dark of the room.

夏洛特：我最好的朋友……苏利丝。
Charlotte: My best friend, Sulis.

她遵从着无形的引导，让自己的躯体灵活地舞动。
She follows the guidance of an unseen force, her body gracefully flowing from one motion to the next.

四周的烛火摇曳晃动，隐约的风声于室内回荡。
The candles surrounding her flicker, and the sound of distant wind rattles through the room.

小孩 III：……夏洛特最近是怎么了？
Kid III: What's going on with Charlotte these days?

小孩 IV：她大概很难过吧……为了这个比赛，她已经很久没有和我们玩了，那个教练又凶巴巴的。
Kid IV: She must be feeling pretty down right now, what with all her practicing for the competition and all. She hasn't played with us for ages, and her coach is just horrible.

小孩 IV：卡洛琳告诉我，她预选赛的成绩很不好。
Kid IV: Caroline told me her qualifier results were rather poor.

小孩 IV：妈妈告诉我，如果你的朋友感到难过，就要好好地安慰她——我们得去安慰夏洛特。
Kid IV: My mum says that when a friend feels sad, you should try to make them feel better. We should do something nice for her!

小孩 III：我真担心她会和西尔莎一样……喂！你干嘛打我？
Kid III: I'm really worried she'll end up like Saoirse—Hey! What did you hit me for?

小孩 IV：别胡说！
Kid IV: Stop talking rubbish!

外面的交谈还在继续，而她已无暇顾及。她感受到了苏利丝的邀请，那是一个比现实更伟大的国度。
The conversation outside continues, but Charlotte doesn't have the time to care. She feels Sulis's invitation to a realm beyond reality.

恍惚间，她看到了那些闪光的草叶，远处有宝石似的花朵正在盛放。金黄色的火苗在天穹上燃烧——太阳在山顶融化了。
In her trance, she sees shining blades of grass and gem-like flowers blooming in the distance. Golden flames burn in the sky, the sun melting into the mountaintop.

夏洛特：以高峰坠低谷，背光明，披迷雾。
Charlotte: Lugh, reborn from dark's embrace, I walk your path, in sacred space.

夏洛特：……生之尽头为死地，亡骨转而为生灵！
Charlotte: Life's end is death, but bones to life ascend!

咚咚咚——
knock-knock-knock

小孩 III：夏洛特，你在吗？
Kid III: Charlotte, are you in?

大地轻微地颤抖了起来，她望着远方的金黄，似乎有什么东西轻轻地蛰了一下她的脚踝。
The ground trembles slightly. She looks at the distant golden light and feels something gently sting her ankle.

咚咚咚咚咚——
knock-knock-knock

小孩 IV：夏洛特，夏洛特……
Kid IV: Charlotte! Charlotte!

夏洛特：噢！
Charlotte: Oh!

脚下的土地剧烈地颤抖着，闪光的草叶狠狠地咬了一下她的脚趾。她吃痛地蹲下，看见了指甲缝里漫延的淤血。
The ground beneath her shakes violently, the shining blades of grass biting hard at her toes. She squats down in pain, watching bruises spread beneath her toenails.

夏洛特：怎么了，苏利丝……
Charlotte: Why? What's wrong, Sulis?

小孩 III：是夏洛特的声音……她在里面！
Kid III: That was Charlotte's voice. She's in there!

大地还在颤抖，她皱起了眉毛，不耐烦地挥开了耳边的虫蝇——它们嗡嗡地叫着，让人心烦意乱。
The ground trembles still. She frowns, impatiently waving away the flies buzzing around her ears. They're making her irritable.

小孩 IV：夏洛特，快开门——我们很担心你！
Kid IV: Charlotte, open the door! We're worried about you!

天空结满白翳，土地渗出鲜血。她的双脚感到一阵钻心的疼痛。
The sky is dense with white clouds and the ground is oozing blood. Her feet are stricken with a sharp pain.

夏洛特：——够了，别来烦我！
Charlotte: Enough! Stop bothering me!

闪亮的草地从眼前褪去了，她一把拉开了大门。
The shining grass fades, and she pulls the door open.

柔光
Flickering Candlelight COL-310406

夏洛特：我再也不想看到你们——！
Charlotte: I never want to see you again!

小孩 III：是……女巫的诅咒……
Kid III: It's the hag's curse!

小孩 IV：啊——！
Kid IV: Ahhh!

赶走了旧朋友之后，女孩回到了屋内。
Having driven away her old friends, the girl goes back inside.

夏洛特：……疗愈的苏利丝，闪耀的苏利丝，神圣的苏利丝。
Charlotte: Healing Sulis, shining Sulis, holy Sulis, to us, you tell.

她在房屋的中央站定，深吸了一口气，脸上露出了淡淡的笑容。
She stands in the center of the house, taking a deep breath, a faint smile on her face.

夏洛特：我唯一的朋友……苏利丝。
Charlotte: My friend. My only friend, Sulis.

简易通讯
Phone Call COL-310407

简易通讯
Phone Call

电话猝不及防地响起了。
The phone rings.

笃笃骨：喂?
Willow: Hello?

卡洛琳：……夏洛特，你看到基金会最新的评议结果了吗?
Caroline Bartley: Charlotte, have you seen the results of the Foundation's latest evaluation?

她语气里的小心翼翼令女巫感到厌烦。
The caution in Caroline's tone annoys her.

笃笃骨：你有什么话，可以直接说出来，我没有你们想象的那么脆弱。
Willow: If you've got something to say, just say it. I'm not as fragile as you think.

笃笃骨：我最恨你们这种弯弯绕绕的样子!
Willow: Good lord, I hate the way you beat around the bush! Just spit it out, will you?

卡洛琳：……
Caroline Bartley: ...

电话彼端的人长长地叹了一口气。
There's a deep sigh from the other end of the line.

卡洛琳：夏洛特，也许你……没有办法去乌卢鲁了。
Caroline Bartley: Charlotte, you might not be able to go to Uluru.

笃笃骨：绝不可能。
Willow: That's impossible.

卡洛琳：经过基金会的评议，他们还是认为……这是不公平的。
Caroline Bartley: After the Foundation's evaluation, they still concluded that ... Well, that it's unfair.

笃笃骨：太荒唐了，我是一个残疾人，为什么会不公平？难道那些选手会害怕从一个瘸子身上占到便宜吗?
Willow: Bollocks! I have one less leg than the rest of you, don't I? I'm a bloody cripple for crying out loud! How could they possibly think I have an advantage?!

笃笃骨：如果她们害怕和一个瘸子竞争，那么这块金牌也没有被争夺的必要了。
Willow: If they're afraid of competing with me because of this leg, then there's no need to compete with them at all.

卡洛琳：……不。
Caroline Bartley: No.

她艰难地说出了接下来的话。
She struggles to utter the subsequent words.

卡洛琳：当然，倘若只以履历评判，不会有人比你更有资格参与这个比赛了。
Caroline Bartley: Of course, judging only on past achievements, no one is more qualified than you to participate.

卡洛琳：但组委会一致认为，如果让你和那些健全的运动员去竞争……这对你是不公平的，夏洛特。
Caroline Bartley: But the committee unanimously agrees that if you compete against able-bodied athletes, it would be unfair to YOU, Charlotte.

笃笃骨：所以——他们体现所谓“公平”的方式，就是剥夺这个残疾人的参赛资格吗?
Willow: What? So barring disabled people from competing is more fair?

笃笃骨：我还能站起来——他们凭什么剥夺我的运动员身份?
Willow: I can still stand, can't I? What right do they have to take this away from me? To strip me of my right to compete?!

笃笃骨：……我还记得那句话。
Willow: I still remember what they said back then.

她露出了一抹惯常的讥笑。
Her habitual sneer makes an appearance.

笃笃骨：“自由祭祀始终还是一个神秘学家的项目，如果只有技术分，那她为什么不去参加别的运动会呢？那儿才是技术分决定一切的地方。”
Willow: "Floor Ritual has always had its roots in arcanum. If she's only here to compete for technical points, why doesn't she compete in another event?"

笃笃骨：他们既然看不起技术分，怎么又能用这个理由将我拒之门外?
Willow: Well, I can hardly rely on technical points now, can I? How could they use such a pathetic excuse to bar me from competing?!

卡洛琳：……
Caroline Bartley: ...

几乎等同于一个世纪一样漫长的死寂。
For what feels like an eternity, there is a dead silence between them.

卡洛琳：抱歉，夏洛特……
Caroline Bartley: I'm sorry, Charlotte.

笃笃骨：该死的……你为什么要道歉!
Willow: Why are you apologizing?!

卡洛琳：……我会再次帮助你申报决赛的名额，尽我最大的努力。
Caroline Bartley: I'll help you apply for the finals again. I'll do everything I can.

笃笃骨：——我不是废物!
Willow: I'm not an invalid!

女巫猝不及防地提高了音调。
Anger bubbles forth.

笃笃骨：我会自己解决这些事情！用不着你的帮忙，收起你那泛滥的怜悯心吧!
Willow: I can fight my own battles! I've fought harder on one leg than most do with two! So you can save your sanctimonious pity for someone else!

笃笃骨：你希望我感谢你吗？你要我如何感激这份恩惠呢？……别忘了，当年拿到金牌的人是我，而你只是个亚军!
Willow: Oh, you want me to thank you, is that it? How exactly should I express my gratitude for this magnanimous favor of yours, eh? Let me remind you—I won the gold medal back then, not you!

卡洛琳：……
Caroline Bartley: ...

卡洛琳：……抱歉，夏洛特。
Caroline Bartley: I'm sorry, Charlotte.

电话被挂断了，听筒中传来了短促的忙音。
The phone call ends.

笃笃骨：……
Willow: ...

女巫紧紧地捏着话筒。
She grips the receiver tightly.

笃笃骨：滚开！
Willow: Leave me alone!!

她重重地扔出了电话机，然后将桌子上所有的东西全扫到了地上，物品碰撞，发出杂乱的响声。
She hurls the phone before sweeping her arm across the table, sending a collection of items clattering to the floor.

笃笃骨：为什么？凭什么？
Willow: Why? Why?!

东西落地的声音在不断响起。
More objects fly around the room.

笃笃骨：该死的——该死的——
Willow: Bloody hell!

无论她发出多大的声响，都不会有人回答她的问题。
四周的居民忌惮于女巫的名声，早已学会对各种异响不闻不问。
No matter how much noise she makes, there is no one to answer her questions. Her neighbors have long learned to ignore the strange noises from this particular residence.

女巫也只能以制造噪音的方式施展她的权能——直到她触摸到了一个小小的匣子。
She screams and crashes around her house. It's the only means she has to expend her energy. Then, her hand touches a small box.

笃笃骨：……
Willow: ...

她意识到了这是什么，颤抖着打开了它。
She halts and opens it with her pale, trembling hands.

奖牌安静地躺在绒布上，与匣子同样陈旧。它的一侧似乎受到过撞击，有一个小小的凹痕。
Inside, her medal lies quietly on its bed of velvet. There's a small dent on one side.

笃笃骨：……
Willow: ...

她记得的，她应当记得的。
She remembers. How could she forget?

叩门的回音
Echoing Knocks COL-310408

叩门的回音
Echoing Knocks

1921，休息室
1921, Locker Room

参赛人员 I：别担心，别紧张……
Competitor I: Come on now; don't be nervous.

参赛人员 II：你是最好的……
Competitor II: You can do this, you can do this!

参赛人员 III：呼……吸……呼……
Competitor III: Breathe in ... breathe out ... breathe in ...

决赛的前一刻，准备室中充满了喧嚣的声音。
It's the moment before the finals. The preparation room is filled with anxious voices.

教练：你今天还好吗?
Coach: Everything alright?

夏洛特：我很好，女士。
Charlotte: I'm fine, Coach.

夏洛特：昨天，苏利丝又回应了我的祈祷……
Charlotte: Sulis responded to my prayers again yesterday.

教练：还有呢?
Coach: And?

女人深深地望着她。
She looks at her intently.

夏洛特：这次，她带我去了一个树林的深处……那里的叶子长着花豹似的纹路，也像眼睛。它们在看着我——像您现在这样，一眨都不眨。
Charlotte: This time, she took me to the heart of a forest. The leaves there had spots all over them, like eyes. They were watching me, just like you are now, without blinking.

夏洛特：我还听见了一个女人的声音。她唱着一支慢悠悠的歌，大概是……
Charlotte: I also heard a woman's voice. She was singing a slow song, something like ...

夏洛特：我记不清歌词了。
Charlotte: I can't quite remember the words.

教练：……
Coach: ...

夏洛特：但我还记得它的节拍。
Charlotte: But I remember the rhythm.

女孩自顾自地跳了起来。
She jumps up and moves in time to it.

夏洛特：疗愈的苏利丝，闪耀的苏利丝，神圣的苏利丝。
Charlotte: Healing Sulis, shining Sulis, holy Sulis, to us, you tell.

夏洛特：您知道吗？那里的草地亮晶晶的，如果我在上面停留得太久，那些小草就会咬我一口。
Charlotte: Do you know it? The grass there sparkled. If I stayed too long on it, the little blades of grass would pinch me.

夏洛特：我只能跳舞，一直跳，一直跳……
Charlotte: All I could do was dance, dance, and keep dancing.

夏洛特：——所以我想，女巫不一定是被烧死的，她们只是踩在了相似的草坪上，对吗?
Charlotte: So, I suppose witches weren't necessarily all burned at the stake. Maybe they just stepped on that kind of grass, you know?

她高高地跃起，随后稳稳地落在了地上。
She leaps high into the air and lands steadily.

夏洛特：每次当我跳起来的时候，那个没有影子的朋友，都会像这样托举着我。
Charlotte: Every time I jump, my shadowless friend lifts me just like this.

流动的能量托举起了她的衣摆。无风的室内，它们发出了飒飒的声响。
Energy flows around her, rustling her hair and leotard.

教练：继续这样跳下去吧。
Coach: Keep dancing, just like this.

教练：只要你能够到达那条路的尽头，你就能摘下那块天穹上的太阳。
Coach: If you make it to the end of this path, you'll snatch the sun right out of the sky.

教练：不要紧张，夏洛特，就把它当做一次平常的训练。
Coach: Don't be nervous, Charlotte. Just treat it like any ordinary practice session.

夏洛特：紧张……?
Charlotte: Nervous?

女孩望向了自己的手心，上面渗出了隐约的汗水。
The girl looks at her palms to find a faint shimmer of sweat.

夏洛特：我不紧张，女士……
Charlotte: I'm not nervous, Coach.

她抬起头，望向远方闪光的太阳。
She lifts her head and gazes at the sun shining in the distance.

教练：……
Coach: ...

那颗闪光而金黄的太阳。
That shining golden sun.

笃笃骨：……
Willow: ...

以及太阳的背面，那些漆黑而无垠的影子。
And behind it, those dark and boundless shadows.

叮铃铃——
ring-ring-ring

门铃声打断了女巫的回忆。
The doorbell interrupts her reminiscence.

笃笃骨：小东西，你记错日子了——
Willow: You've got the day wrong, girl.

她一瘸一拐地走向了门口，用力地打开了房门。
She hobbles to the door and opens it with force.

笃笃骨：今天不是送蜗牛的日子!
Willow: Today isn't snail day—

笃笃骨：……怎么是你?!
Willow: What are you doing here?!

眼前的访客出乎了她的意料。
The visitor before her comes as a surprise.

卡洛琳：夏洛特，我必须得告诉你这个消息——你一定会为此高兴的。
Caroline Bartley: Charlotte, I have some news I simply must tell you. You'll be utterly delighted to hear it, I'm sure.

笃笃骨：什么?
Willow: What?

卡洛琳：基金会办事处的人说，他们可以让你参与这个比赛……作为特殊的选手，进行的比赛。
Caroline Bartley: The Foundation has decided that they'll let you participate in the competition ... as a special athlete.

卡洛琳：你又可以重新回到赛场上了。
Caroline Bartley: You can return to the floor again!

不请自来的访客正喋喋不休地讲述着。
She chatters on.

笃笃骨：——滚出去。
Willow: Get out!

卡洛琳：……为什么？
Caroline Bartley: Why?

笃笃骨：还需要我告诉你为什么吗？
Willow: Oh, you want to know why?

女巫咬着牙露出一抹冷笑。
She sneers through gritted teeth.

笃笃骨：你来到这里，只为了嘲笑我吗？
Willow: What is that you want? You wonder why I don't want to stroke your ego? To pump air into your already overinflated head?!

笃笃骨：如果你不辞辛劳地跑到这里，只是为了在我面前炫耀你那些可怜的成绩……
Willow: You're just here to brag about your achievements!

笃笃骨：那么我告诉你——你成功了！
Willow: Then, congratulations! You've done the job!

笃笃骨：你满意了吗？卡洛琳，我现在是一个瘸子、一个废物，没办法再和你站在同一个赛场上了——是啊，你终于能以强者的姿态来怜悯我了，对吗？
Willow: Are you satisfied, Caroline? I'm a cripple—a failure. Not your competition, but the object of your pity. That's what you wanted, right?

卡洛琳：我从未如此想过……
Caroline Bartley: I'd never thought of it that way.

她还想申辩什么，但此情此景，一句安慰远比一把刀子锋利。
She wants to argue, but in this moment, a word of comfort cuts sharper than any blade.

笃笃骨：即使他们愿意邀请我，那也只是“特殊邀请”的“表演赛”……可笑！该死的表演赛，我难道是个演员吗？
Willow: As if they'd invite me to perform in an "exhibition," like I'm some kind of monkey to be gawked at in a zoo. It's ridiculous!

笃笃骨：……非要我全部说出来吗，卡洛琳？一定要我亲口告诉你吗？我在这些年过得是多么的糟，人们讨厌我，连身体都背叛了我！
Willow: Do I have to tell you it all, Caroline? How awful my life has been all these years? How people hate me? How my body has failed me?!

笃笃骨：你的自尊心因此而得到满足了吗？
Willow: Does it satisfy your ego?

笃笃骨：滚出去！我再也不想看到你！
Willow: I don't want to see you ever again!

卡洛琳：——夏洛特！
Caroline Bartley: Charlotte!

叩门的回音
Echoing Knocks COL-310409

一份纸质文件落在了地上，上面印着圣洛夫基金会的标识。
A document falls to the ground. It bears the logo of the St. Pavlov Foundation.

笃笃骨：这是……
Willow: This is ...

她摊开了那份文件。
She unfolds the document.

笃笃骨：“关于夏洛特·奥黑根的参赛决议……”
Willow: "Regarding the Decision on the Participation of Ms. Charlotte O'Hagan ..."

笃笃骨：“经过流程与评议，我们同意让夏洛特·奥黑根作为‘自由祭祀’参赛选手，参加乌卢鲁运动会的决赛。”
Willow: "Upon careful consideration and evaluation, we hereby consent to Ms. Charlotte O'Hagan competing as a Floor Ritualist in the finals of the Uluru Games."

笃笃骨：……什么意思?
Willow: What's the meaning of this?

女巫惊疑不定地望向卡洛琳。
She looks at Caroline in disbelief.

卡洛琳：也许是我说得不够清楚，但是……
Caroline Bartley: Perhaps I didn't make myself clear, but ...

卡洛琳：你并不是以“演员”的身份去参加比赛，夏洛特，你是货真价实的运动员——这一点从未变过。
Caroline Bartley: You're an athlete, not a performer. You won't be competing in an "exhibition." Nothing has changed, Charlotte.

卡洛琳握紧了那双颤抖的手。
Caroline holds Willow's trembling hands in her own.

卡洛琳：很期待能在赛场上看见你。
Caroline Bartley: I look forward to seeing you on the floor.

领奖台
Podium COL-310410

领奖台
Podium

1921，乌卢鲁赛场
1921, Uluru Stadium

广播：让我们恭喜夏洛特·奥黑根！
Broadcast: Congratulations, Charlotte O'Hagan!

奖牌沉甸甸的重量压在了她的脖子上，闪光灯在四处亮起，恍惚间她觉得自己正置身于一个永恒的白昼中。
The weight of the medal presses on her neck as camera bulbs flash all around her, leaving her a little dazzled.

记者 I： 快——拍下她脚上的伤疤！
Reporter I: Quick—snap a picture of the scar on her foot!

记者 II： 夏洛特选手！恭喜你在乌卢鲁运动会上获得冠军！
Reporter II: Charlotte, congratulations on winning first place at the Uluru Games!

记者 II： 你打破了历史纪录，是“自由祭祀”年龄最小的获奖者——针对这一路上的艰辛付出，你有什么想说的吗?
Reporter II: That's a surprise. You've smashed the record, making history as the youngest ever winner of Floor Ritual. What was the process like to get to this point?

夏洛特： ……
Charlotte: ...

她低下头，金灿灿的奖牌正悬置于她的胸前。
She lowers her head, examining the shining gold medal hanging at her chest.

夏洛特： 我摘到了太阳。
Charlotte: I snatched the sun from the sky.

记者 II： 太阳?
Reporter II: The sun?

女孩微笑着举起了那块金牌。
The girl smiles and raises the gold medal.

夏洛特： 没错，这是我的太阳。
Charlotte: That's right. This is my sun!

记者 I： ——绝佳的角度，这是一张优秀的版面图。夏洛特，可以把金牌举高一点吗?
Reporter I: Perfect angle, real front page material. Charlotte, could you lift the medal a bit higher?

女孩将金牌举得更高了，无数闪光灯使那块金牌熠熠生辉。
The girl raises the medal higher. The camera flashes, making it shine even brighter.

记者 I： 太好了……我们计划在下周进行一个专访……
Reporter I: Great. We plan on doing an exclusive interview next week.

记者 III： 菲利普，你占用太多的时间了！
Reporter III: Hey, Philip, haven't you hogged enough of her time?

一个记者挤到了夏洛特的面前，他的西装因为拥挤而显得皱巴巴的。
A reporter pushes his way toward Charlotte, his suit wrinkled from the jostling crowd.

记者 III： 轮到我了！夏洛特选手，你接下来的目标是什么……
Reporter III: Finally! Alright. Charlotte, what's next for you?

女孩被淹没在了话语声和闪光灯中。
The girl is overwhelmed by questions and flashing lights.

喧闹结束了。
The cacophony has come to an end.

夏洛特： ……只是如此吗?
Charlotte: Is that it ...?

那块沉甸甸的金牌正被摆放在她的手心。
The medal rests heavy in her palm.

夏洛特： ……我赢了，但是然后呢?
Charlotte: I won, but now what?

教练：你还太小了。
Coach: You're still so young.

一阵熟悉的脚步声传来。
Familiar footsteps approach.

教练：在此之前，你曾听闻的所有故事，都停留在了“获得金牌”的这一刻。
Coach: The stories we tell always end with winning the gold.

教练：没有人告诉你，获得金牌之后又该做什么——故事很轻易地就可以拥有结局，但人生远比故事要漫长。
Coach: No one talks about what you're supposed to do after you win the medal. After all, life goes on much longer than any story.

夏洛特：——可是我拿到了金牌！
Charlotte: But I did it! I got the gold!

她奋力地为自己争辩着。
She argues fiercely on her own behalf.

夏洛特：我打败了卡洛琳，刷新了所有人的纪录——我是最年轻的冠军，在之前的历史从来没有过 11 岁的冠军！
Charlotte: I broke the record. I beat Caroline! I'm the youngest champion ever! There's never been an 11-year-old champion in all history!

教练：……所以呢？
Coach: So what?

夏洛特：我的名字会被记在报纸上……所有人都会记住我。在下一次乌卢鲁运动会上，他们会叫着我的名字，为我加油……
Charlotte: My name will be in the newspapers. Everyone will remember who I am, and at the next Uluru Games, they'll all be cheering my name.

夏洛特：然后……
Charlotte: And then ...

教练：然后你的名字就会成为一个标志、一个符号——出现在人们即兴的演说和茶余饭后的谈资中。连你自己都只会沉溺于昔日的幻影，成为追逐另一个符号的牺牲者。
Coach: Your name will become a symbol, a topic at every dinner table conversation, and, as even you fall prey to the illusion of fame and the past, it will become your prison.

教练：直到你忘却自己应该是什么样子。
Coach: And before long, you will have entirely forgotten who you thought you were.

夏洛特：我……
Charlotte: I—

教练：人总有死亡的一天，但“自由祭祀”永远存在——它就是符号本身。个人意志太过脆弱，又怎么可能战胜一个坚不可摧的符号？
Coach: We all die one day, but the Floor Ritual will carry on. It's the symbol itself. How could someone possibly defeat something abstract?

教练：夏洛特，你的悲剧从今天开始了。
Coach: Today is the beginning of your tragedy.

女人冷酷地宣告着判决。
She coldly announces her verdict.

教练：当你直视太阳时，别忘了阳光与阴影同出一源。
Coach: When you look directly into the sun, you must always remember that it's also the source of shadow.

夏洛特：……我为它付出了那么多的努力。
Charlotte: I've sacrificed so much for this.

她攥紧了那枚金牌。
She clutches the gold medal tightly.

夏洛特：我战胜了所有人，才拿到了它——它就是金牌……
Charlotte: I beat everyone to get it—the gold medal. I woke up at the crack of dawn, trained until I could train no more, just for a chance.

夏洛特：我要从很早就起床，练习到身心俱疲，才能换来一个拥有它的可能性——但现在，我拿到它了……
Charlotte: And now, I've won.

夏洛特：你以为我看不出其他人眼里的渴望吗？这是她们想拿又拿不到的东西……
Charlotte: Do you think I can't see the desire in their eyes when they see it? They all want this medal.

她咬了咬牙，鼓起勇气直视着教练。眼前女人的面孔如同涟漪，正在轻微地颤动着。
She bites her lip and musters the courage to look her coach in the eye. The face before her ripples, trembling slightly.

夏洛特：——如果它正是悲剧的起源，我们又为什么会渴望它?
Charlotte: If this is the source of tragedy, then why do we long for it?

教练：……呵。
Coach: Heh.

随着女人的冷笑声，她的样貌逐渐变得清晰。
As she lets out a cold sneer, her features become clearer.

教练：它不需要任何理由——因为它是金牌。
Coach: It's the gold medal. That's why.

教练：正是因为它是金牌，所以你就走了下去。哪怕双脚鲜血淋漓，你也无法摆脱这场有关于自我的祭祀——因为这就是你自找的！
Coach: It's precisely because it's a gold medal that you kept going. Even if your feet were bleeding, you couldn't escape this self-inflicted sacrifice. Because this is what you desired!

教练：……这不就是你可悲的根源吗?
Coach: Isn't this the root of your tragedy?

再见，朋友
Goodbye, Friend COL-310411

教练：拿到了金牌之后，你接受了采访，有了专栏，成为了风头无两的人物。
Coach: After winning the gold medal, you gave interviews, featured in columns, and became renowned among arcanists.

教练：可那又怎么样呢?
Coach: But so what?

孩子：妈妈，那是夏洛特的屋子，她很久没有……
Child: *Mum, that's Charlotte's house! It's been so long since she—*

女人：别说出她的名字——她是女巫！说出她的名字只会让你招致灾祸。
Woman: *Shh. Don't you go saying her name. She's a witch, understand?! A hag! It's written right there in her name!*

教练：没有人愿意谈论你的名字，也没有人愿意经过你门前的小径。
Coach: No one is willing to speak your name. No one even dares walk past your house.

教练：你的花园再也没有花朵开放，杂草长遍了每一寸荒芜的角落。
Coach: Your garden no longer blooms. Only weeds sprout from the mud and dirt.

夏洛特：这不可能！为什么……
Charlotte: So, then ...

教练：因为战争追上了你。
Coach: Then, the war began.

夏洛特：战争……
Charlotte: War?

教练：是的，你还没见到——不过你总会见到的。
Coach: That's right. You haven't seen it yet, but you will.

教练：战争摧毁了你的故乡。你跟随家人一起搬到了一处民居。
Coach: Years ago, war destroyed your hometown, and you moved with your family to a new land.

教练：理论上这是一个安全的地方，你听信了别人的话语，坚信交战的双方不会对这里开火。
Coach: On the surface, it seemed like a safe place. You believed what everyone said, firmly convinced that there would be no fighting there.

夏洛特：……这不是很好吗?
Charlotte: Isn't that a good thing?

教练：你还记得那一天吗?
Coach: I suppose you don't yet remember that day.

夏洛特：那一天?
Charlotte: That day?

教练：是的，那一天……
Coach: Yes, that day.

教练：以现在的标准来看，那一天算不上一个好日子，到处都是硝烟的味道。军队在附近投掷了太多的炸弹，四处都是废墟与尘埃。
Coach: By modern measures, that day was far from a good one. The air was heavy with the stench of gunpowder after the military dropped bomb after bomb in the area, leaving debris and dust in their wake.

教练：但至少，你的居住地还未经炮火洗礼。你得以在战争中苟全自身。
Coach: But luckily, your house was untouched, and you managed to survive the war.

夏洛特：然后呢?
Charlotte: Then what?

教练：抬头看。
Coach: Look up.

女孩抬起头——一轮金灿灿的太阳，她不可思议地望着眼前的一切，随后揉了揉眼睛。
The girl looks up. There is a shining golden sun before her. She gazes in disbelief, then rubs her eyes.

夏洛特：我怎么会在训练室里看到太阳……
Charlotte: How come I can see the sun in the training room?

教练：那一天，你也在天空上看到了类似的太阳。
Coach: You saw a similar sun in the sky on that day, too.

教练：久候不至的和平似乎终于要到来——因为你已经很久没有听到飞机的轰鸣了，荒芜的草地上，似乎有了生命的影子。
Coach: That long-awaited peace seemed to finally be near. You hadn't heard the roaring of planes for a long while, and the desolate grasslands had started to show a hint of life.

教练：于是，在那片空旷的焦土上，你开始了舞蹈。
Coach: So, on that stretch of scorched earth, you began to dance.

教练：……盛日之眼，平衡的守护者，你是无尽之泉。
Coach: Eye of Day, Keeper of Balance. You are the Endless Well.

夏洛特：疗愈的苏利丝，闪耀的苏利丝，神圣的苏利丝。
Charlotte: Healing Sulis, shining Sulis, holy Sulis, to us, you tell.

教练：你还记得“自由祭祀”的由来吗?
Coach: Do you remember the origins of the Floor Ritual?

夏洛特：当然，我记得——“自由祭祀”来源于古老的祭祀仪式。远古的巫祝为了避免纷争而进行舞蹈，请求苏利丝的眷顾。
Charlotte: Of course, I remember. Floor Rituals originate from ancient rituals. The shamans danced to avert strife, to implore Sulis's grace.

夏洛特：可以说，它最初是祈求和平的舞蹈。
Charlotte: It was originally a dance for peace.

教练：那个时候，你也是这么想的。
Coach: So you thought at that time.

教练：你看见了闪光的太阳，土壤由贫瘠变得丰沃，细嫩的绿芽破土而出。
Coach: You saw the glorious sun, the soil turning from lifeless to fertile, the tender green sprouts breaking through the earth.

教练：这是你此生最成功的舞蹈，苏利丝第一次回应了你的祈求——从来没有人能在乌卢鲁的赛场上做到这些，即使是当初的你也不行。
Coach: That was the most successful dance of your life. For the first time, Sulis responded to your prayers. No one had ever done that at the Uluru Games before, not even you at your best.

教练：你第一次听到了某种尖锐的哨声——当然，以后你还有很多回顾的机会，因为它会在你的噩梦中永无止息地出现，就像阿拉克尼那张永远织不完的网。
Coach: You heard that sharp whistling for the first time—that sound that still haunts you in every nightmare, like Arachne cursed to forever make her web.

教练：很快，一枚炮弹在你的身边爆炸了。
Coach: Soon, an incendiary bomb exploded beside you.

夏洛特：——!
Charlotte: ...!

教练：你因此失去了自己的腿——很可惜，你最后还是没有得到神明的眷顾。
Coach: So you lost your leg as a result. It seems that, in the end, the gods never favored you.

教练：可怜的人，她的信仰从此变成了一个笑话——如果献祭一切只能获得这样的结果，这所谓的神明最好还是从未存在过。
Coach: Poor girl. Her beliefs have become a joke. If sacrificing everything yielded such results, it would be better if those so-called gods never even existed.

教练：这也是你之后每一个日夜痛苦的根源——一个不相信神的人，怎么能再次获得神明的垂青呢?
Coach: And it has caused you never-ending pain. How can one who no longer believes in the gods ever receive their favor again?

她露出了讥嘲的冷笑。
She sneers mockingly.

夏洛特：不可能……苏利丝是我的朋友。
Charlotte: No. That's not true. Sulis is my friend.

教练：可怜的小东西。
Coach: You poor little thing.

教练：看看你胸口的奖牌吧。
Coach: Look at that medal hanging around your neck.

女孩托起了那枚金牌，上面有一个小小的凹痕。
The girl lifts the medal to find a small dent in it.

夏洛特：——!
Charlotte: ...!

教练：你记得这个缺口吗?
Coach: Do you remember how this dent got here?

夏洛特：这不是我的金牌！我的金牌绝不会有这样的痕迹……!
Charlotte: This isn't my medal! My medal would never have a dent like this in it!

教练：在腿断掉之后，你用力把它扔了出去，含泪赌咒再也不要看到它。
Coach: After you lost your leg, you threw your medal away as hard as you could, cursing through tears that you'd never set eyes on it again.

教练：很可惜，诅咒没有生效。
Coach: Unfortunately, your curse didn't work.

夏洛特：……
Charlotte: ...

门外响起了一阵敲门声。
There's a knock at the door.

???：您好，有人在吗?
???: Hello? Is anyone there?

夏洛特：是谁?
Charlotte: Who is it?

???：女巫小姐？这是这周的蜗牛!
???: Ms. Willow? I've got this week's snails!

是一个陌生的声音。
The voice is unfamiliar.

教练：夏洛特，我是来向你告别的。
Coach: I'm here to say goodbye.

夏洛特：为什么?
Charlotte: Why?

教练：因为我的蜗牛到了——如果我不去开门，那个小东西会一直等下去。
Coach: My snails have arrived. If I don't open the door, that little scamp will be kept waiting.

教练：一分钟，十分钟，一个小时……谁知道呢，小东西的想法很奇怪，谁也不知道她会在门口等多久。
Coach: A minute, ten minutes, an hour ... That girl's mind is a mystery. Who knows how long she'll wait?

教练：所以我必须去开门。
Coach: I need to answer the door.

夏洛特：我还能见到您吗?
Charlotte: Will I see you again?

教练：如果可以的话，我希望你永远不要遇见我。
Coach: If it were possible, I'd hope you never do.

女人摇了摇头，随后露出无奈的微笑。
She shakes her head and reveals a helpless smile.

教练：可是我们总会遇见的，夏洛特。许多结局并不经由人的选择而产生，也无法因为人的意志而改变。
Coach: But we will meet, Charlotte. Endings aren't always a matter of choice, nor can they be changed through will alone.

教练：我想，现在正是说再见的时候——保管好这块金牌，别迁怒它。
Coach: Now, the time has come to say goodbye. Take good care of this medal, won't you? Don't take your anger out on it.

女人离开了这里。
She makes her way out of the room.

她的行走姿态僵硬而局促，腿部发出了古怪的摩擦声。但脖颈依旧挺得笔直，就像一只黑色的天鹅。
Her movement is stiff and awkward, and her leg makes a strange scraping sound as she walks. Yet, still, she holds her neck high, like a black swan gliding on the water.

夏洛特：……
Charlotte: ...

笃笃骨：呼……
Willow: *sigh*

纸信圈儿：女巫小姐，这是这周的蜗牛！
Flutterpage: Ms. Willow, here are the snails for this week!

那只装满蜗牛的洋铁桶被一只苍白消瘦的手接过。
The jar of snails is taken by a thin, gloved hand.

笃笃骨：……你的报酬在门口的邮筒里。
Willow: Your payment's in the letterbox by the door.

笃笃骨：还有，谢谢。
Willow: And ... thank you.

纸信圈儿：……天哪，女巫小姐，你说了什么？你说了谢谢！
Flutterpage: Wow, Ms. Willow! What was it you said just now? Did you say "thank you"?!

纸信圈儿：我从来没有听你说过这个词，你真的是女巫小姐吗?
Flutterpage: I ain't never heard you say that word before! Are you sure you're Ms. Willow?

笃笃骨：……
Willow: ...

她照旧把蜗牛摆在了桌面上，它们逐渐从壳中伸出了柔软的脑袋。
She places the snails on the table as usual, their soft heads gently emerging from their shells.

每周一次的田径比赛还在继续，经过漫长的等待，第三只蜗牛率先抵达了终点。
The weekly race begins, and after a long wait, the third snail is the first to reach the finish line.

笃笃骨：最后的获胜者是……3 号选手。
Willow: The victor is ... Number 3.

笃笃骨：你赢了。
Willow: You won.

她收集了蜗牛留下的黏液，将它们熬煮成一锅淡黄色的膏脂——是的，这些应该足够在这次行程中使用。
She gathers the snail mucus and works it into a light yellow salve. This should suffice for the trip.

女巫正在收拾行李，她已经太久没出过远门了。
She prepares her luggage, reflecting on the many years since her last excursion.

笃笃骨：澳大利亚……那里的太阳很厉害，也许我该带一个更大的帽子。
Willow: Australia ... The sun is relentless there. I should probably bring a larger hat.

笃笃骨：还有更多的润滑脂……
Willow: Still, I have a fair deal of lubricant remaining.

笃笃骨：噢！还有这个……
Willow: Oh, and there's this too.

她看到了那个小小的匣子。
She looks at the little box.

里面装着那块金灿灿的奖牌，上面有着一个小小的凹陷。
Within it lies the gleaming gold medal with the dent on one side.

笃笃骨：……
Willow: ...

鲜花、掌声、欢呼、润滑脂、金灿灿的太阳，以及一千道影子。
Flowers, applause, cheers, lubricant, the golden sun, and a thousand shadows.

她轻轻地吻了吻奖牌的缺角。
She gently kisses the dented edge of the medal.

笃笃骨：晚安，我的朋友。
Willow: Good night, my friend.